



PRELUDE
LEARNING & CONSULTANCY

FREE RESOURCE · SELF-ASSESSMENT WORKBOOK

Capability Readiness Review

Ten questions to test whether you understand the problem well enough to invest in a solution. The printable companion to the online self-assessment.

Version 1.0 · October 2026

Prepared by Prelude Learning & Consultancy Ltd

prelude-learning.com/capability-readiness-review.html

BEFORE YOU START

About this workbook

Most organisations know something isn't working. Fewer can say with confidence what the problem is, what is causing it and what success would look like. This workbook tests how clearly you can answer those questions before you commit money and time to a solution.

Purpose

The Capability Readiness Review™ is the first step Prelude takes before any investment in training, consultancy, systems or organisational change. This workbook contains the same ten questions, response options and scoring method as the free online self-assessment at prelude-learning.com, so the two give the same result.

Who should complete it

The sponsor or manager who owns the problem, ideally with two or three others who see it from different angles: someone who does the work, someone who manages it and someone who will judge whether it has been fixed. Differences in your answers are often the most useful finding.

How to use it

1. Agree, in one sentence, the issue you are assessing. Write it in the box below.
2. Answer each of the ten questions honestly. Tick one response per question. "Not sure" is a legitimate answer and scores zero.
3. Use the evidence prompts to note what supports your answer. If you can't point to evidence, consider whether "Partly" or "Not really" is more accurate.
4. Calculate your score on the scoring worksheet and read the interpretation.
5. Complete the risk and action-planning pages for any questions you scored at 0 or 1.

The issue we are assessing

Completed by, and date

WHAT THIS SELF-ASSESSMENT CAN AND CANNOT TELL YOU

This is an **indicative self-assessment**. The result is based only on your own answers. It is not an independently validated audit, it has not been statistically validated as a measurement instrument, and it does not establish compliance with any standard. Its value lies in the conversation it prompts and the gaps it exposes.

PART 1

The ten questions

Tick one response for each statement.

01 We can clearly state the problem we're actually trying to solve.

AREA: PROBLEM DEFINITION

Yes, clearly 3	Partly 2	Not really 1	Not sure 0
☐	☐	☐	☐

Evidence prompts

- Can you state the problem in one or two sentences without naming a solution?
- Would the sponsor, the manager and the people doing the work describe it in the same way?
- Is the problem written down anywhere?

Notes and evidence

02 We know which behaviours need to change.

AREA: BEHAVIOUR CHANGE

Yes, clearly 3	Partly 2	Not really 1	Not sure 0
☐	☐	☐	☐

Evidence prompts

- Can you describe the required behaviour in observable terms: what someone would see or hear?
- Do you know who needs to behave differently, and in which situations?

Notes and evidence

03 We're clear on the impact we're trying to achieve.

AREA: TARGET IMPACT

Yes, clearly 3	Partly 2	Not really 1	Not sure 0
☐	☐	☐	☐

Evidence prompts

- What will be different for the organisation, its customers or service users if this works?
- Is the impact expressed in operational or business terms, not as an activity?

Notes and evidence

04 We've defined what 'good' looks like.

AREA: STANDARDS OF 'GOOD'

Yes, clearly 3	Partly 2	Not really 1	Not sure 0
☐	☐	☐	☐

Evidence prompts

- Is there a written standard, specification or example of good performance?
- Do managers apply the same standard?

Notes and evidence

05 We know how success will be measured.

AREA: SUCCESS MEASUREMENT

Yes, clearly 3	Partly 2	Not really 1	Not sure 0
☐	☐	☐	☐

Evidence prompts

- Which measure will tell you the problem is solved?
- Do you have a baseline for that measure today?
- Who will collect it, and when?

Notes and evidence

06 We have evidence supporting our view of the current position.

AREA: EVIDENCE BASE

Yes, clearly 3	Partly 2	Not really 1	Not sure 0
☐	☐	☐	☐

Evidence prompts

- What data, observation or records support your view?
- Have you heard directly from the people who do the work?
- Which parts of your view are assumptions?

Notes and evidence

07 We've genuinely tested whether training is the real problem.

AREA: TRAINING VS CAPABILITY

Yes, clearly 3	Partly 2	Not really 1	Not sure 0
☐	☐	☐	☐

Evidence prompts

- Have you confirmed that people lack the knowledge or skill, rather than assumed it?
- Could people perform correctly if the process, tools and workload allowed?
- Has previous training on this topic made a lasting difference?

Notes and evidence

08 We understand the organisational barriers in the way.

AREA: ORGANISATIONAL BARRIERS

Yes, clearly 3	Partly 2	Not really 1	Not sure 0
☐	☐	☐	☐

Evidence prompts

- What gets in the way of good performance: process, systems, roles, workload, priorities, incentives?
- Which barriers are within your control to change?

Notes and evidence

09 We understand the risks if nothing changes.

AREA: RISK OF INACTION

Yes, clearly 3	Partly 2	Not really 1	Not sure 0
☐	☐	☐	☐

Evidence prompts

- What happens in six or twelve months if nothing is done?
- Who owns that risk, and do they know it?

Notes and evidence

10 We know what capability is required to achieve the outcome.

AREA: CAPABILITY REQUIREMENT

Yes, clearly 3	Partly 2	Not really 1	Not sure 0
☐	☐	☐	☐

Evidence prompts

- Can you describe what the organisation must be able to do, reliably, to deliver the outcome?
- Is that requirement agreed with the people accountable for the outcome?

Notes and evidence

PART 2

Scoring worksheet

Enter the score for each question (Yes, clearly = 3; Partly = 2; Not really = 1; Not sure = 0). Tick the final column for any question scored 0 or 1: these are your **areas of risk**.

#	Area	Score (0–3)	Scored 0 or 1?
01	Problem definition		☐
02	Behaviour change		☐
03	Target impact		☐
04	Standards of 'good'		☐
05	Success measurement		☐
06	Evidence base		☐
07	Training vs capability		☐
08	Organisational barriers		☐
09	Risk of inaction		☐
10	Capability requirement		☐
Total (maximum 30)			

CALCULATE YOUR READINESS SCORE

Readiness score (%) = total ÷ 30 × 100, rounded to the nearest whole number.

Example: a total of 19 gives $19 \div 30 \times 100 = 63\%$.

Our readiness score %

Our band (see next page)

PART 3

Interpreting your result

The bands below are the same as those used by the online self-assessment.

80–100%	Strong readiness	You have real clarity on the problem and how to solve it. The priority now is execution and assurance: making sure the right capability is built and measured.
60–79%	Developing readiness	The foundations are there, but a few gaps could undermine your investment. Closing them before you commit will sharpen the outcome.
40–59%	At risk	There's enough uncertainty here that investing in a solution now carries real risk. A structured review would protect the spend and the outcome.
0–39%	High risk: not yet ready	The real problem isn't yet defined clearly enough to solve. This is where a facilitated Capability Readiness Review is most useful.

A high score is only as reliable as the evidence behind it. If several of your “Yes, clearly” answers rest on assumption, treat the result as one band lower.

Areas of risk and potential root causes

For each question you scored at 0 or 1, the table shows the likely underlying issue.

#	Area of risk	Potential root cause
01	Problem definition	No agreed definition of the real problem
02	Behaviour change	Unclear which behaviours must change
03	Target impact	No defined target impact or outcome
04	Standards of 'good'	'Good' isn't defined or shared
05	Success measurement	No agreed measures of success
06	Evidence base	Decisions resting on assumption rather than evidence
07	Training vs capability	Defaulting to training before diagnosing the cause
08	Organisational barriers	Structural or governance barriers left unaddressed
09	Risk of inaction	Risk of inaction not understood or owned
10	Capability requirement	Required capability not yet defined

Recommended next steps

If you scored 0 or 1 on...	Next step
Q1 Problem definition	Define the single problem you're solving before commissioning any solution.
Q7 Training vs capability	Test whether training is genuinely the answer using the Training vs Capability Decision Model™: is the knowledge or skill actually missing?
Q5 Measurement or Q6 Evidence	Agree how success will be measured, and gather a baseline, up front.
Q8 Organisational barriers	Map the organisational barriers before designing any intervention.
Q10 Capability requirement	Define the capability actually required to achieve the outcome.
Overall score below 60%	Consider a facilitated Capability Readiness Review to turn these gaps into an evidence-based plan.
No questions at 0 or 1	Move to design and assurance, and confirm your evidence for each "Yes, clearly".

PART 4

Evidence and risk

Evidence summary

List the evidence you relied on. Label each item E (evidence), I (inference) or A (assumption).

Question(s)	What we know, and how we know it	E / I / A	What we still need to find out

Risk identification

What could go wrong if you proceed with the current plan, or if nothing changes? Rate likelihood and impact as High, Medium or Low.

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Owner	Mitigation

PART 5

Improvement priorities and action plan

Start with the questions you scored lowest. Choose no more than three priorities: closing a few gaps properly is worth more than starting on all ten.

#	Priority gap	Action to close it	Owner	By when	How we will know it is done
1					
2					
3					
Decision: are we ready to invest in a solution?					
If not, what must be true before we are?					
Date to repeat this review					

Optional: comparing team responses

If several people complete the review, record each person's score per question. A spread of two or more points on any question signals that the issue is not yet understood in the same way.

#	Area	A	B	C	D	E	Spread
01	Problem definition						
02	Behaviour change						
03	Target impact						
04	Standards of 'good'						
05	Success measurement						
06	Evidence base						
07	Training vs capability						
08	Organisational barriers						
09	Risk of inaction						
10	Capability requirement						

Next steps with Prelude

The self-assessment is the starting point. A facilitated Capability Readiness Review tests your answers against evidence and stakeholder input, and gives you a prioritised view of the real problem and what to do about it.

Self-assessment

This workbook, or the online version: indicative results based on your responses.

Read the playbook

The Capability Readiness Playbook™ explains the method behind these questions.

Facilitated review or full diagnostic

Structured evidence-gathering and analysis, scaled to the size of the decision.

Discuss a challenge

prelude-learning.com/contact
jason.smith@prelude-learning.com

© 2026 Prelude Learning & Consultancy Ltd. Registered in England and Wales, Company No. 16918049. You may print and copy this workbook for use within your own organisation. It may not be sold, republished or distributed as part of another product without written permission. Capability Readiness Review, Capability Diagnostic and Training vs Capability Decision Model are trade marks used by Prelude Learning & Consultancy Ltd (™ denotes an unregistered trade mark). This workbook is an indicative self-assessment tool. It is not an audit, does not provide professional advice for a specific situation and does not establish compliance with any standard or regulation.